



PHOTO BY AMIT PASRICHA

A Healthy Report

▶ IN THE PAST FIVE YEARS, CIPLA HAS NEARLY DOUBLED ITS PROFITS

▶ THE PHARMA MAJOR HAS ALSO CUT ITS DEBT BY 87 PER CENT DURING THIS PERIOD

	FY18	FY19	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23
Revenue from operations (₹ crore)	15,219	16,362	17,132	19,160	21,763	22,753
EBITDA (₹ crore)	2,826	3,171	3,230	4,303	4,578	5,027
PAT (₹ crore)	1,411	1,528	1,547	2,405	2,517	2,802
Total debt (₹ crore)	4,098	4,316	2,816	1,756	824	520
EBITDAM (%)	18.6	19.4	18.9	22.5	21.0	22.1
PATM (%)	9.3	9.3	9.0	12.6	11.6	12.3

EBITDAM

EARNINGS BEFORE INTEREST, TAXES, DEPRECIATION AND AMORTISATION (EBITDA) MARGINS; PATM: PROFIT AFTER TAX (PAT) MARGINS;

SOURCE
ACE EQUITY

53

leader in chemistry. Back home, he founded The Chemical, Industrial & Pharmaceutical Laboratories (his son renamed it Cipla in 1984). He struck gold with anti-malarial drugs during World War II.

In 1995, Cipla launched the world's first oral iron chelator, used to treat conditions with excess iron in the body, such as thalassaemia or haemochromatosis. Becoming a founding member of the Indian Pharmaceutical Alliance in 1999, Cipla was a champion of generic drugs in India.

Cipla hit world headlines during the AIDS epidemic when it offered a three-drug cocktail of antiretroviral therapies (ART) for \$350 a year or less than a dollar a day to poor countries against the \$12,000 charged by multinational giants. Cipla's cocktail was a lifeline for African governments and local charities battling HIV, which causes AIDS. While there is still no cure for AIDS, the ARTs have turned it into a manageable chronic condition. Multinational drugmakers finally gave licences to companies

such as Cipla to make the drugs for poor countries.

During the avian flu pandemic of the noughties, Cipla made its inexpensive version of Tamiflu, which had been discovered by Gilead Sciences in 1995, patented in 1996, and commercially launched in November 1999. Cipla launched its generic version of flu drugs, oseltamivir and zanamivir.

Today, Cipla has a diverse portfolio and dominates segments such as respiratory drugs, urology, anti-infectives and chronic diseases. In